

INTERNSHIP REPORT

1. Introduction

During my internship I worked within the sustainable fashion and digital innovation sector, at the company called COSH!. It's a platform that connects conscious consumers with certified sustainable brands across different cities. They work with multiple audiences at once: local governments (who fund them and want insight into shopping behaviour in their cities), retail members (brands that pay to be listed and need visibility online), and everyday consumers who they want to guide toward more sustainable choices through sharing their insights online, promoting to shop from their members and through the COSH! Digital wardrobe app.

What struck me most was how complex that balance is. COSH! doesn't just make pretty content, they offer dashboards with shopping data, a brand index that scores how sustainable a brand actually is, webinars, content days, online research, and a whole ecosystem around conscious fashion. Learning to create communication that serves all those layers at once was one of the biggest challenges, and the most valuable lesson.

But what I'll carry with me the longest is something more personal: I learned to be critical. Before this internship, I assumed that second-hand automatically meant sustainable. I thought shopping at Think Twice was a responsible choice: it's second-hand, so it must be good, right? But I started asking different questions: Where does the money actually go? What about the lack of transparency, the environmental cost of transport? Is there genuine support for charities, or is that just part of the image?

I also learned that materials matter in ways I hadn't considered. Recycled polyester, for example something H&M promotes as eco-friendly, is still polyester. It doesn't biodegrade. That realisation made me want to pay more attention to what my clothes are actually made of, and to prioritise natural fibres like 100% cotton or wool.

And then there's greenwashing; something I found genuinely eye-opening and, honestly, sometimes unfair. You can't just use the colour green in your branding anymore without risking a fine, even if your brand really is sustainable. The rules are strict, and while I understand why, it feels unjust when truly committed brands get penalised alongside the ones that are just performing sustainability for profit.

Through this internship I learned that sustainability isn't just about the fabric of a garment; it's about who made it, under what conditions, whether they were paid fairly, and how transparent the whole chain is. It made me more thoughtful, more questioning, and honestly, a little less naive. And I think that's exactly the kind of growth an internship should bring.

2. Description of Tasks, Achievements, and Link to My Educational Programme

My internship was strongly connected to the learning outcomes of my programme, especially in terms of communication design, content creation, visual storytelling, project organisation, and professional collaboration. Below are three of my #productvandeweek achievements, each from different categories of professional skills.

#productvandeweek 1: Fashion Revolution Week Social Media Campaign

Professional skill: Creative content production, campaign development

My specific input: Together with Taraneh, an intern from Germany studying business management, I co-organised the entire week of content for Fashion Revolution Week. It was honestly a bit stressful

at times coordinating everything day by day while keeping the quality consistent wasn't easy. But that's also what made it so rewarding, especially getting a lot of compliments afterwards from colleagues. We divided our strengths naturally: I took the lead on all the visual design, while Taraneh handled the research and wrote the captions and post texts. It became a real collaboration between two different disciplines, and I think that showed in the result.

One detail I'm particularly proud of is the circle placed at the centre of the Instagram feed. It symbolised the idea of a truly circular fashion system. One where a garment's entire lifecycle is considered, from ethical production and conscious consumption to repair, reuse, and eventual recycling. Inspired by the vision of moving away from a traditional linear supply chain towards a closed-loop system, the circle became a simple but powerful way to visualise continuity, responsibility, and connection within fashion. Translating such a layered and complex concept into something visually engaging and accessible was a meaningful creative challenge during my internship. If you'd like to learn more about circular supply chains, you can read the article on <https://cosh.eco/en/articles/evolution-of-circular-supply-chains>

What I learned: I learned how to balance creativity with educational clarity, and how to stay calm and keep working when things get hectic. I also discovered how much better the outcome can be when you collaborate with someone whose skills genuinely complement your own.

Why I chose it: This project shows the breadth of what I can do visual design, creative ideation, planning across multiple formats, and the ability to carry real responsibility during an important brand moment. But it also shows something I value just as much: knowing how to be part of a team.

#productvandeweek 2: Digital Product Passport Visuals (DPP)

Professional skill: Conceptual design, UX/UI thinking, long-term project development

My specific input: The Digital Product Passport is one of the most forward-thinking projects COSH! is currently working on, and I was involved from the very beginning. The concept is straightforward but powerful: every clothing piece will have a QR code that, when scanned, reveals the full value chain of that product: where it was made, who made it, under what conditions, what materials were used, how to wash it, how recyclable it is,... It's about making transparency the standard in fashion, which aligns with everything COSH! stands for.

We worked together with a third party for the technical development, while my role sat firmly on the design side. I worked through multiple versions in Figma, refining screens, building out visual systems, and shaping how the passport would look and feel; both digitally and on the physical label visible from the outside. Throughout the process I incorporated feedback from colleagues and the CEO, attended meetings and webinars on DPPs, and researched the topic in depth to make sure the design decisions were grounded in the actual legislation and requirements.

What I learned: I gained a real understanding of how design and legislation can and must work together. Working iteratively over several weeks taught me how to take feedback constructively and improve with each round, rather than starting over.

Why I chose it: This project meant a lot to me because it sits at the intersection of everything I find meaningful in design: clarity, transparency, and purpose. I didn't just execute visuals, I helped shape how an important idea gets communicated to the world.

Do you want to know more about the DPP? Take a look at the article on [www.cosh.eco](https://cosh.eco/en/articles/eu-digital-product-passport-espr-explained-fashion-textiles) : <https://cosh.eco/en/articles/eu-digital-product-passport-espr-explained-fashion-textiles>

#productvandeweek 3: Competitor Analysis of Seven+ Apps

Professional skill: Research, analytical skills, structured reporting

My specific input: I carried out a full competitor analysis of apps similar to the COSH! Digital Wardrobe, including platforms like Whering and Indyx. For each one, I went through the complete onboarding experience downloading the app, trying out every feature, and documenting everything along the way. I documented everything in a structured Excel file. My research included general information, unique value propositions, first impressions, interaction and navigation, visual design, content, features, pricing, branding, and user reviews. For every platform, I analysed both the strengths and weaknesses, not only in terms of functionality and usability, but also from a visual and branding perspective. This helped me gain a clearer understanding of what works well within the user experience and where improvements or missed opportunities existed.

After completing the research, I turned the findings into an article together with Andrei, a fellow intern, who strengthened it with SEO, making sure the right keywords were used strategically so the content would actually be found online. The whole process then fed directly into a meeting with Bits of Love, the UX company collaborating on the development of the app's new house style, where I got to sit in and contribute to the conversation. Although the rebranding is still in development and has not yet been made public, I can mention that a new visual identity is currently being developed.

What I learned: I learned how to analyse digital products critically. Not just aesthetically, but functionally. It sharpened my eye for UX decisions and gave me a much better understanding of what makes an app feel intuitive versus frustrating. It also improved my ability to work independently and organise large amounts of information in a clear, usable way.

Why I chose it: This project is a concrete example of how research can directly shape strategy. The work I did didn't just sit in a file somewhere, it became the foundation for real decisions about the future of the app.

3. Personal Development

During my internship, I learned a lot about myself, both professionally and personally. I discovered that I can adapt more easily than I thought, that I am capable of growing outside my comfort zone, and that challenges often help me become more confident. Two situations in particular really deserve the hashtag #proudoftmyself because they taught me important lessons about how I handle feedback, communication, and personal growth.

The first situation was related to receiving feedback during the beginning of my internship.

Situation: At the start of the internship, I sometimes struggled during feedback moments. I noticed that I often took feedback personally, especially when it was communicated in a direct or stressed way. After certain meetings, I would feel upset, not necessarily because of the feedback itself, but because of the tone in which it was delivered.

Task: I realised that if I wanted to grow professionally, I needed to learn how to separate feedback about my work from my personal emotions. I wanted to become more confident, more professional, and less emotionally affected by these situations.

Action: Instead of avoiding feedback moments, I consciously tried to change my mindset. I reminded myself that my colleagues were also human beings with busy schedules and stressful workloads, and that they were not trying to hurt me personally. I started focusing more on the content of the feedback rather than the delivery. Whenever I received comments, I tried to analyse how they could improve my work instead of overthinking them emotionally. Over time, I became calmer and more open to criticism.

Result: By the end of the internship, I noticed a big difference in how I handled feedback. I became more professional and emotionally balanced, and I understood that constructive criticism is necessary in order to improve. This experience taught me that I can sometimes be an overthinker and quite sensitive, but also that I am capable of managing those feelings and turning them into personal growth. Looking back, I am proud that I learned not to take everything personally and that I became more confident in a professional environment.

The second situation I am especially proud of is related to speaking English.

Situation: During the past three years at university, I often felt insecure about speaking English. Even though the entire course was in English, I regularly avoided speaking up because I was afraid people would immediately notice my mistakes. As someone who is naturally social once I feel comfortable, this insecurity sometimes stopped me from fully expressing myself.

Task: One of the reasons I chose my study programme was actually to improve my English and become more confident in an international environment. During my internship, I wanted to challenge myself and stop avoiding conversations in English.

Action: Throughout the internship, I was surrounded by international colleagues and another intern from Romania, which meant I had to communicate in English every day. Instead of avoiding conversations like I sometimes did at school, I pushed myself to actively participate, ask questions, and have casual conversations. The more I spoke, the more comfortable I became. I realised that communication is not about speaking perfectly, but about connecting with people and expressing yourself clearly. Something that gave me even more confidence was noticing that people genuinely laughed at my jokes and enjoyed talking with me in English. It may sound small, but for me it was a big moment because it made me realise that I could still be myself, show my personality, and connect with others in another language. That really helped me overcome my insecurity and feel more confident in international conversations.

Result: By the end of the internship, I had spoken more English than I probably had during the previous three years at school combined. I became much more confident and realised that I was actually capable of communicating well in an international environment. This experience taught me that my insecurity was mostly caused by fear and overthinking, not by my actual abilities. It became a real #proudoft myself moment because I finally proved to myself that I can do something I had struggled with for years.

2. Personality Test Reflection (ESFJ-T)

Based on the personality test, I recognise myself strongly in the ESFJ-T profile. Several traits were clearly visible during my internship at COSH!, especially in the way I collaborate, communicate, and react to feedback and structure.

E -> Extraverted

I recognise my extraverted side in the way I prefer working with others rather than independently. Or just working in a room together with colleagues. During my internship, I often asked colleagues for feedback or advice instead of finalising tasks on my own. I was not afraid to ask questions, and I found it important to involve others in my process. I also enjoyed working collaboratively on projects.

Outside of direct project work, I naturally tried to create a positive and social atmosphere in the workplace. I greeted colleagues in the morning, smiled at people in the building, and tried to be approachable. I noticed that small interactions like these contributed to a more connected working environment, which I value a lot.

S -> Sensing

I strongly recognise my preference for concrete and clear information rather than abstract instructions. I prefer when tasks are clearly defined, and I find it challenging when expectations are vague or change without clear communication. In those situations, I need clarity in order to work efficiently.

I also notice details very quickly, especially in visual work. During my internship, I often immediately recognised small design mistakes or inconsistencies in other work, which helped me improve my own attention to detail. At the same time, I learned that some skills are best developed through practice. When working with new platforms, reading instructions was often not enough; I needed to actively try things out, make mistakes, and improve through experience.

F -> Feeling

I make decisions based on the impact they have on people and I care strongly about tone, meaning, and communication style. During my internship, I became aware that I am very sensitive to the atmosphere within a team. If someone seemed quieter or stressed, I sometimes interpreted this as being my responsibility and felt the need to reassure them or make sure everything was okay.

I also care about how my work affects others. I prefer communication that feels respectful and clear, and I value creating a positive environment for colleagues. When I noticed that someone was having a difficult or stressful day, I often tried to support them or make the atmosphere lighter. This reflects my tendency to prioritise emotional awareness and interpersonal harmony in a working context.

J -> Judging

I work best in structured environments where tasks, deadlines, and expectations are clear. I prefer organising my work and planning steps rather than working in chaotic or undefined situations. Having clarity helps me feel more in control and productive.

During my internship, I also realised that I like finishing tasks properly and making sure everything is completed to a high standard. I feel more comfortable when I can wrap up work in a structured and organised way, rather than leaving things open-ended.

T -> Turbulent

The turbulent aspect of my personality is visible in the way I reflect a lot on my performance. I tend to think deeply about feedback and sometimes doubt myself, especially when feedback is delivered in a direct or emotional tone.

However, I also experienced that I improve quickly when I receive feedback and apply it. During my internship, I learned to gradually separate criticism from personal emotion, which helped me become more confident and balanced in professional situations.

4. Critical Reflection on the Internship and My Study Programme

Relation between education and practice

My educational programme corresponds well with the skills I used during my internship at COSH!, especially in communication design, UX/UI thinking, research, and visual storytelling. Many tasks felt familiar, such as creating social media content, structuring research, and designing digital visuals.

However, I also noticed a clear difference between school and professional practice. At school, I usually create a concept or branding from scratch, while at COSH! I had to work within an existing brand identity/house style and apply it consistently across many formats such as Instagram posts, reels, campaigns, pitch decks, and templates. For example, instead of developing a visual identity, I had to translate COSH!'s existing tone into seasonal campaigns.

Another important difference is the complexity of real workflows. In my competitor analysis and UX projects, feedback from colleagues, external partners, and meetings (such as with Bits of Love) often influenced or adjusted the direction during the process. This made the work more dynamic than school assignments, where feedback moments are usually more structured and final.

Added value of the internship

The biggest added value of this internship is that I worked on real, publishable projects with actual impact. I created and published a large variety of Instagram content (campaigns, research carousels, reels, and informational posts), contributed to UX/UI design in Figma for the Digital Product Passport, and conducted a full competitor analysis of multiple apps by testing real onboarding flows and documenting everything in Excel and Figma.

This showed me how design, research, and strategy are connected in a professional environment, where decisions are influenced by sustainability goals, legislation (such as ESPR and DPP requirements), and multiple stakeholders.

On a personal level, I also developed a lot in confidence. I improved my English communication in an international team, became more comfortable asking for feedback, and learned to handle criticism in a more professional way instead of taking it personally.

Positive points

1. Real and diverse professional experience

I worked on a very wide range of tasks: social media content, UX/UI design, video editing, research, campaign development, and pitch decks. For example, I managed Instagram campaigns for awareness days, edited reels for partner brands, and worked on the Digital Product Passport over several weeks in Figma. This variety gave me a realistic view of different roles within a creative company.

2. Responsibility and independence

I was trusted with important tasks such as UX/UI design, competitor analysis, and content production. For example, I personally installed and tested more than seven apps, analysed their onboarding flows, and structured all findings in Excel and Figma. This helped me work more independently and build confidence in my own decisions.

3. Collaboration in a real professional environment

I worked closely with designers, marketers, developers, another intern, and external partners like Bits of Love. I also participated in meetings and feedback sessions where decisions were discussed collaboratively. This helped me understand how multidisciplinary teams function in real projects.

Less positive points

1. Tasks were sometimes unclear or evolving

Some tasks were not fully clear at the beginning or changed during the process. For example, in certain design or UX tasks, I had to ask multiple times for clarification before fully understanding the expectations.

2. Fast-paced and overlapping workload

Multiple projects were running at the same time (social media, UX research, campaigns), which sometimes made prioritising difficult. This required a lot of flexibility and organisation to keep track of deadlines and tasks.

3. Limited time for deeper exploration

Due to deadlines and ongoing workflows, there was often limited time to fully explore multiple design directions. For example, in Figma UX projects, I sometimes had to move forward quickly instead of testing several creative variations.

Conclusion

This internship helped me connect my education to real professional practice. It showed me that design is not only creative, but also strategic, structured, and influenced by external factors such as sustainability, legislation, and stakeholder input. At the same time, it helped me grow personally by becoming more confident, more independent, and more comfortable in an international working environment.